



Access and interpret product information

D2.TTA.CL2.01

Assessor Manual



Access and interpret product information

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Assessor Manual

Project Base

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Table of contents

Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors.....	1
Competency standard.....	11
Oral questions.....	21
Written questions	27
Answers to written questions	35
Observation checklist.....	47
Third Party Statement.....	51
Competency recording sheet	55

Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: ACCESS AND INTERPRET PRODUCT INFORMATION		NOMINAL HOURS: 80
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTA.CL2.01		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to access and explain domestic and/or internal tourism-specific information to support sales activities.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Identify and evaluate sources of product information 1.1 List potential <i>sources of product information</i> 1.2 Determine usefulness of product information sources 1.3 Identify <i>items that may contain product information</i> Element 2: Access product information 2.1 Select appropriate sources of product information 2.2 Register to receive and/or access product information 2.3 Visit suppliers and other sources to talk with sales staff and obtain items that may contain product information		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to work in the travel industry within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel Agencies 2. Tour Operation <i>Sources of product information</i> may relate to: • Internal business sources, including databases and reservation systems either manual or computerised • Direct contact with: ▪ Travel suppliers, including airlines, cruise operators, railway operators, bus lines, car rental businesses, limousine hire and taxis ▪ Suppliers and providers of support and ancillary services, including travel insurance providers, finance providers, currency exchange, conference and similar venues and interpreters

2.4 <i>Access selected internal databases and internal business systems</i> 2.5 <i>Access external sources of product information</i> Element 3: Interpret product information 3.1 <i>Identify specific sales needs that form the basis for the search for product information</i> 3.2 <i>Read items that may contain product information</i> 3.3 <i>Integrate sourced product information with identified client needs and/or preferences</i> Element 4: Provide product information 4.1 <i>Interpret industry terminology</i> 4.2 <i>Pass on general information relating to products and services</i> 4.3 <i>Explain specific details about product and services</i>	▪ Tour operators and wholesalers ▪ Travel agencies and associations ▪ Peak travel bodies ▪ Government tourism industry bodies and authorities, including domestic and international bodies • Literature, including reference books, magazines and newspapers • Websites, including individual companies, directories, news sites, surveys and research sites • Personal network of contacts, including those within the host enterprise and those external to the business <i>Product information may relate to:</i> • Travel, including air, cruise, train, bus, car • Destinations, including statistical information and details relating to climate, currency, maps, travel guides, events, languages, history, safety, government information, time zones, culture and communications • Tourist activities and attractions, including natural and man-made • Tours, trips, sight-seeing and excursions • Accommodation facilities, including 5-star to back-packer venues • Services, including medical, personal, entertainment, sporting, shopping • Travel requirements, including requirements relating to entry, passport, visas, warnings and advisory bulletins, customs information • Finance • Travel insurance.
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	<i>Determine usefulness</i> may include: • Defining enterprise needs • Assessing validity, reliability, accuracy, currency and sufficiency of information provided • Evaluating method and speed of access to information provided • Identifying ease of access to information provided • Appraising cost of obtaining information • Complying with enterprise policies and commercial agreements, including agency, sub-agency and franchise requirements • Reviewing the utility of sources on a regular basis. <i>Items that may contain product information</i> will include: • Brochures • Timetables • Tariff sheets, including confidential tariff schedules • Sales and promotion kits • Supplier information kits • Product manuals • Advertising fliers • Manufacturer's specifications • Websites, including downloads from same. <i>Register</i> may include: • Registering on-line • Paying a fee
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	• Establishing required password and username, if required • Lodging host enterprise details with product information source • Establishing the <i>bona fides</i> of the host enterprise • Joining an association or body in order to enable access. <i>Access selected internal databases</i> may include: • Obtaining internal authority to access required fields of information • Setting-up password access authority • Determining folders, documents and locations to use. <i>Access external sources</i> may include: • Telephoning organisations, bodies and authorities • Going on-line • Requesting a visit from sales staff from other organisations. <i>Specific sales needs</i> may relate to: • Non-negotiable client needs, including budget, timing, duration of travel, required destination and activities, health • Requests from and preferences of client, including general enquiries and special interest requests, travel preferences, timing and designated destination activities • Need to provide quotations • Processing a reservation, including booking and coordinating supplier services and products • Issuing non-air documentation • Processing financial transactions, including payment of deposits and full-payment for bookings
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	• Need to amend an existing booking due to unforeseen circumstances • Cancellations and/or alterations made to bookings. <i>Integrate sourced product information</i> may include: • Matching availability and data to identified client needs and preferences to the best extent possible • Searching for possible alternatives and options • Converting supplier codes and abbreviations into usable data to adequately interpret the information provided. <i>Industry terminology</i> may include: • Industry jargon • Industry specifications • Common abbreviations • Industry and supplier/provider codes • Use of 24-hour international time clock • Technical capacity of equipment. <i>Products and services</i> may include: • Transportation and transfers • Accommodation, meals, functions and entertainment • Tours, cruises and entry to attractions • Tour guide services and activities • Special events, including special event consumable items • Venue and convention facilities, including equipment to support same • Speaker, audio-visual, catering, health and financial services.
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	<i>Specific details</i> may include: • Costs, tariffs and rates • Conditions and rules • Scheduling information • Product codes • Booking procedures • Points of departure and arrival • Touring inclusions and exclusions • Technical specifications for audio-visual and other meetings and events equipment. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Understanding and following the enterprise's policies and procedures in regard to accessing product information both internally and externally • Knowledge of major categories of tourism products and services • Using industry terminology, jargon and abbreviations • Ability to convert to and from international time • General knowledge of destinations and travel options • Understanding of the advantages and disadvantages of travel choices, destinations, activities and other travel-related purchasing options. Linkages To Other Units • Access and retrieve computer-based data • Develop and update local knowledge • Maintain quality customer/guest service
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- Use common business tools and technology
- Develop and update tourism industry knowledge
- Promote products and services to customers
- Operate a computerised reservation system
- Maintain product information inventory
- Source and provide destination information and advice
- Construct and apply tourism product research
- Promote tourism products and services.

Critical Aspects of Assessment

Evidence of the following is essential:

- Understanding of arrangements that exist to determine sources of information that are to be used
- Demonstrated ability to evaluate and rate nominated sources of information against given criteria
- Demonstrated ability to access a nominated range of information sources both electronically and paper-based to identify a designated set of information
- Demonstrated ability to communicate product information to clients to meet identified needs and preferences

Context of Assessment

Assessment must ensure:

- Actual or simulated workplace application of techniques to access and interpret product information.

	Resource Implications Training and assessment must include the use of real equipment, with access to the Internet, databases, facilities and products.		
	Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Observation of practical candidate performance • Case studies • Role plays • Oral and written questions • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work.		
	Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Determine and evaluate suitable sources of product information
	Communicating ideas and information	1	Explain product information to clients
	Planning and organising activities	1	Schedule review of product information sources

	Working with others and in teams	1	Liaise with industry partners and other staff to access and identify relevant information as required by the client
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Calculate costs to ensure compliance with client budget
	Solving problems	1	Develop alternatives for clients to enable their requirements to be met as best as possible
	Using technology	1	Research and access information via the Internet

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Access and interpret product information D2.TTA.CL2.01
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Why is having product knowledge important for someone working in the travel and tourism industry?	☐	☐
2. What are examples of questions you could ask to assess information needs?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. Besides the use of text-based and image based materials, what other materials contain valuable product and services information?	☐	☐
4. What are considerations when identifying timelines for accessing information?	☐	☐
5. Why is registering for product information a valuable tool? What are two ways you can register for product information?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What are the benefits of establishing networks with external businesses and their staff when accessing product information?	☐	☐
7. When seeking product knowledge from internal sources, who can you receive information from?	☐	☐
8. What are the advantages of accessing product information from external sources than just relying on internal sources?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. Why is it important to identify specific sales needs before searching for product information?	☐	☐
10. Why is it important to verify completeness, accuracy and currency of product information you have collected?	☐	☐
11. Why is it important to integrate information gathered to meet client needs?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Why is it important to interpret industry terminology before passing on information to the client?	☐	☐
13. What are the different methods to pass on information to clients? What are the advantages of each method?	☐	☐
14. What are examples of terms and conditions that may apply to arranging travel activities?	☐	☐

Written questions

Access and interpret product information – D2.TTA.CL2.01

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. Identify two categories of travel and tourism businesses. For each category, identify two types of businesses that can be found.

2. Identify three types of products and services information you may seek to meet the needs of a customer.

3. When seeking information regarding flights for customers, what are the three types of information would you access?

4. Why is it essential to access only useful product knowledge information?

5. What are methods used to determine usefulness of product information?

6. What are examples of text based materials that may contain product knowledge?

7. What are examples of imaged based materials that may contain product knowledge?

8. What are considerations when determining a budget for accessing and interpreting information?

9. What are two methods that can be used to search identified sources of product information?

10. What are objectives when contacting external sources for product information?

11. What are two ways you can make contact with tourism businesses when trying to access product information?

12. Besides receiving product information from external sources, at time you may seek external assistance. What are two purposes of seeking external assistance?

13. What are the benefits of visiting identified external businesses supplying product information?

14. What are three examples of internal product information sources?

15. What are the two main options for storing product information internally in an organisation?

16. What are examples of Global Distribution Systems that can be used to access product information?

17. How would you determine appropriate tourism businesses to gather product information from?

18. What are two examples of sales needs that need to be considered when determining which product information to access?

19. What are methods used to ensure accuracy of product information collected?

20. What are the objectives of reviewing captured information?

21. How can you interpret product information that you have accessed?

22. What are examples of activities associated with manipulating captured information to meet the needs of the client?

23. What are the categories of information is normally contained in a quotation?

24. What are methods used to interpret industry terminology?

25. What are examples of tourism and travel industry codes, abbreviations and terminology that need to be understood and translated?

26. What are examples of terminology commonly associated with the accommodation industry?

27. What are the key pieces of information in a quotation that needs to be communicated to a client?

28. If your client was requesting information regarding a tour, what information would you need to explain to the client?

29. Besides general information regarding tourism products and services, what are types of specific details that need to be communicated with the client during the presentation of a quotation?

30. What are examples of booking conditions that need to be communicated with a client?

Answers to written questions

Access and interpret product information – D2.TTA.CL2.01

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. Identify two categories of travel and tourism businesses. For each category, identify two types of businesses that can be found.

Answers will be varied.

Categories may include:

- Airlines
- Other travel suppliers
- Suppliers and providers of support and ancillary services
 - Accommodation
 - Attractions and Theme Parks
 - Tour Operators
 - Inbound Tour Wholesaler
 - Outbound Tour Wholesaler
 - Retail Travel Agents
 - Local, regional and national information services
 - Meetings and Events
 - Ministries of Tourism
 - Tourism Boards
 - Industry Authorities
 - Industry Associations.

2. Identify three types of products and services information you may seek to meet the needs of a customer.

- Destination information
- Local community information
- International destination information
- Tours
- Attractions
- History
- Geographical features
- Local customs and culture
- Climate

- Accommodation
- Amenities and services
- Airlines
- Car hire
- Cruises
- Transfers
- Rail.

3. When seeking information regarding flights for customers, what are three types of information would you access?

- Airline or combination of airlines
- Airport codes
- Airline codes
- City codes
- Flight numbers
- Schedules / timetables
- Destinations
- Routing
- Origin and destination
- Code share flights
- Normal fares
- Discounted fares, including infants, children, students, pensioners and groups
- Fares for unaccompanied children
- Promotional fares and packages
- Taxes
- General air travel rules and restrictions
- Class of travel
- Stopovers
- Mileage restrictions allowed
- Minimum and maximum stays
- Ticketing time limit
- Payment conditions.

4. Why is it essential to access only useful product knowledge information?

- To demonstrate the professionalism
- To answer routine questions
- Provide destination information and advice
- Provide specific product advice
- To provide additional information
- To advise customers of up-coming events
- To make recommendations and suggestions
- Selling tourism products
- Quote specific individual tourism product prices
- Booking and coordinating services
- Receiving and processing reservations
- Processing financial transactions
- Issuing customer travel documentation
- Issuing itineraries
- Explain the features of the products
- To generate repeat business from customers
- To generate referral business
- To comply with general operational requirements.

5. What are methods used to determine usefulness of product information?

- Defining enterprise needs
- Assessing validity, reliability, accuracy, currency and sufficiency of information provided
- Evaluating method and speed of access to information provided
- Identifying ease of access to information provided
- Appraising cost of obtaining information
- Complying with enterprise policies and commercial agreements, including agency, sub-agency and franchise requirements
- Reviewing the utility of sources on a regular basis.

6. What are examples of text based materials that may contain product knowledge?

- Brochures, flyers and pamphlets
- Product manuals
- Supplier information and sales kits
- Confidential and general industry tariffs
- Preferred contracts or agreements
- Clue cards
- Fare sheets
- Industry publications, advices and notices
- Media articles
- Travel literature
- Travel guides
- Newspapers and magazines
- Timetables
- Reports
- Summaries
- Marketing materials and books.

7. What are examples of imaged based materials that may contain product knowledge?

- Photographs
- recordings
- Videos
- Posters
- Atlases and maps.

8. What are considerations when determining a budget for accessing and interpreting information?

- Time allocation to undertake research
- Staff to undertake research or assist in the analysis, preparation and presentation of the material captured
- Funds to obtain secondary research data
- Funds to enable the undertaking of primary market research
- Materials, registrations, subscriptions and other activities necessary to register to receive or to purchase identified information.

9. What are two methods that can be used to search identified sources of product information?

- Subscribing to publications
- Reading newspapers
- Getting on Internet e-mail lists
- Joining your local union or industry association
- Reading articles on the industry sector
- Getting out and having a look around
- Interrogating databases
- Asking
- Conducting web based searches
- Exploring options.

10. What are objectives when contacting external sources for product information?

- Making contact with tourism businesses
- Introducing your business to the organisation
- Identify if the tourism business 'fits' your company profile or image
- Gain an understanding of the tourism products and services they provide
- Understand their 'promotional message' and how to promote their products and services
- Discuss contractual agreements and terms and conditions for working together
- Requesting product information.

11. What are two ways you can make contact with tourism businesses when trying to access product information?

- Telephoning targeted businesses
- Making face-to-face requests of sales staff that visit the office
- Making e-mail requests
- Registering to receive information, newsletters and up-dates.

12. Besides receiving product information from external sources, at time you may seek external assistance. What are tow purposes of seeking external assistance?

- To gather further information
- For acquisition of specialised information
- To interpret existing information gathered
- Provide findings and recommendations
- To clarify information
- To answer any questions.

13. What are the benefits of visiting identified external businesses supplying product information?

- Meet key personnel
- Talking with personnel to obtain, clarify, update and identify supplementary relevant information
- Gain an understanding of the operation
- Viewing operations and making personal observations
- Clarify and explain your request for information
- Receive electronic and hard copy files in a user friendly manner
- Reviewing additional information available at the source
- Get any questions answered
- Identify the potential of informational sources that can be utilised at a later date
- Recording interviews and taking photographs or other recorded images.

14. What are three examples of internal product information sources?

- Customer databases
- Sales figures
- Internal reports
- Accounting and operational statistics
- Data from sub-agencies and head office
- Customer feedback information
- Automated information systems
- Computerised reservation systems
- Products and services inventories.

15. What are the two main options for storing product information internally in an organisation?

- Manual filing systems
- Computerised systems.

16. What are examples of Global Distribution Systems that can be used to access product information?

- Travelport (Galileo & Apollo)
- Travelport (Worldspan)
- Amadeus
- Sabre.

17. How would you determine appropriate tourism businesses to gather product information from?

Answers will be varied based on personal opinions.

18. What are two examples of sales needs that need to be considered when determining which product information to access?

- Consultation with client
- Non-negotiable client needs, including budget, timing, duration of travel, required destination and activities, health
- Requests from and preferences of client
- Source and provide information and advice
- Make recommendations
- Check availability and prices
- Provide quotation including booking terms and conditions
- Processing a reservation, including booking and coordinating supplier services and products
- Collect applicable deposits and provide to applicable parties
- Provide written confirmation and due dates for final payment
- Collect final payment and provide to applicable parties
- Processing financial transactions, including payment of deposits and full-payment for bookings
- Issue or secure non-air and air travel documentation and provide to customer
- Need to amend an existing booking due to unforeseen circumstances
- Cancellations or alterations made to bookings.

19. What are methods used to ensure accuracy of product information collected?

- Identify date in which current information was compiled
- Checking version of the brochure or information
- Checking on the website for accurate 'real time' information
- Contacting the supplier to verify information.

20. What are the objectives of reviewing captured information?

- Confirming the applicability and utility of material researched and provided
- Determining degree of usefulness of the information
- Determining if additional information, material or data is required to meet identified needs
- Verifying the accuracy, relevance and sources of the data
- Ensuring that no obvious sources of information have been overlooked
- Meeting with the information user to check that the material gathered is appropriate for their needs
- Meeting with researchers to clarify points of ambiguity, as appropriate.

21. How can you interpret product information that you have accessed?

- Analysis and interpreting the information
- Classifying the information
- Preparing summaries with supporting evidence of the results of the data analysis.

22. What are examples of activities associated with manipulating captured information to meet the needs of the client?

- Preparing a quotation
- Matching availability and data to identified client needs and preferences to the best extent possible
- Searching for possible alternatives and options
- Converting supplier codes and abbreviations into usable data to adequately interpret the information provided.

23. What are the categories of information is normally contained in a quotation?

- General information
- Travel products and services information
- Specific details.

24. What are methods used to interpret industry terminology?

- Understanding resources, including interpreting codes, abbreviations, acronyms and individual supplier terminology
- Converting currencies
- Interpreting terms and conditions
- Understanding limitations and elements of products and services, especially packages and deals
- Identifying fees and charges.

25. What are examples of tourism and travel industry codes, abbreviations and terminology that need to be understood and translated?

- Phonetic alphabet
- The 24-hour clock
- Airport city codes
- Airline codes.

26. What are examples of terminology commonly associated with the accommodation industry?

Double (DBLB)	Two people sharing a room with a double/queen/king bed provided
MAX PAX	Maximum people allowed in the room
Roll away	Extra sleeping accommodation which is rolled away during the day
Run of house (ROH)	Passengers will be allocated the most suitable room type upon check in to the hotel
Sole use	One person using the room only
Season	The date range applicable to a particular rate
Split season cost	This applies when a client's stay is spread over different seasons
Twin share (TWN)	Two people sharing a room with two single or double beds provided
B&B	Bed and breakfast
BBP	Bed and breakfast provisions
BCB	Bed and continental breakfast
Check-in time	The earliest time the passengers may check-in to the room
Check-out time	The latest time the passenger must check-out of the room
Late check-out	Where the check-out time is extended FOC or it has been pre-booked and pre-paid
Late arrival	Usually an arrival after 1800 hours
Credit card guarantee	Credit card number provided to hotel in order to hold the room
Hotel Club	Loyalty program

27. What are the key pieces of information in a quotation that needs to be communicated to a client?

- Details about physical products
- Information about the services that are available
- Information on prices, Specials, deals and packages
- Providing personal interpretation and explanation of the quotation
- Providing supplementary information as required
- Explaining the reasons for charges and fees included in the quotation
- Assisting the client to understand the reputation and expertise of nominated suppliers, providers and carriers
- Providing supporting brochures and marketing materials to assist with understanding of the quotation.

28. If your client was requesting information regarding a tour, what information would you need to explain to the client?

- Tour company name
- Tour name, code and duration
- Departure date, time and location/city
- Arrival date, time and location/city
- Rooming details – single, twin, triple
- Inclusions.

29. Besides general information regarding tourism products and services, what are types of specific details that need to be communicated with the client during the presentation of a quotation?

- Seasonality
- Availability
- Costing considerations
- Additional travel costs
- Product price increases
- Fluctuations in exchange rates
- Booking conditions
- Terms and conditions
- Scheduling information
- Product codes
- Booking procedures
- Points of departure and arrival
- Touring inclusions and exclusions

- Technical specifications for audio-visual and other meetings and events equipment
- Travel insurance
- Limitations
- Safety and risk – adventure products
- Non operation of the product – tour cancellation.

30. What are examples of booking conditions that need to be communicated with a client?

- How to book – who to contact
 - Amount of deposit required
 - Prices and validity
 - Assumption of risk
 - Exclusion of liability
 - Payment deadline
 - Ticketing deadline
 - Extension ticketing deadline
 - Cancellation by the supplier
 - Force Majeure
 - Cancellation by the travel agent
 - Cancellation charges
 - Availability of any type of change to booking
 - Availability of changes to class of booking
 - Types of booking amendments
 - Amendment fees
 - Complaints
 - Authority of suppliers and tour leaders
 - Baggage allowance
 - Excess baggage charges
 - Health, fitness and age limits
 - Publicity
 - Privacy
 - Governing law.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Access and interpret product information D2.TTA.CL2.01
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Identify and evaluate sources of product information - Access product information - Interpret product information - Provide product information - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Identify and evaluate sources of product information		
List potential sources of product information	☐	☐
Determine usefulness of product information sources	☐	☐
Identify items that may contain product information	☐	☐
Element 2: Access product information		
Select appropriate sources of product information	☐	☐
Register to receive and/or access product information	☐	☐
Visit suppliers and other sources to talk with sales staff and obtain items that may contain product information	☐	☐
Access selected internal databases and internal business systems	☐	☐
Access external sources of product information	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 3: Interpret product information		
Identify specific sales needs that form the basis for the search for product information	☐	☐
Read items that may contain product information	☐	☐
Integrate sourced product information with identified client needs and/or preferences	☐	☐
Element 4: Provide product information		
Interpret industry terminology	☐	☐
Pass on general information relating to products and services	☐	☐
Explain specific details about product and services	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor
--

Improvements needed:

General comments:

Candidate signature

Date

Assessor signature

Date

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Access and interpret product information D2.TTA.CL2.01		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Identify and evaluate sources of product information			
List potential sources of product information	☐	☐	☐
Determine usefulness of product information sources	☐	☐	☐
Identify items that may contain product information	☐	☐	☐
Element 2: Access product information			
Select appropriate sources of product information	☐	☐	☐
Register to receive and/or access product information	☐	☐	☐
Visit suppliers and other sources to talk with sales staff and obtain items that may contain product information	☐	☐	☐
Access selected internal databases and internal business systems	☐	☐	☐
Access external sources of product information	☐	☐	☐

Element 3: Interpret product information			
Identify specific sales needs that form the basis for the search for product information	☐	☐	☐
Read items that may contain product information	☐	☐	☐
Integrate sourced product information with identified client needs and/or preferences	☐	☐	☐
Element 4: Provide product information			
Interpret industry terminology	☐	☐	☐
Pass on general information relating to products and services	☐	☐	☐
Explain specific details about product and services	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**Third party signature:****Date:****Send to:**

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Access and interpret product information	D2.TTA.CL2.01
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Identify and evaluate sources of product information						
List potential sources of product information						
Determine usefulness of product information sources						
Identify items that may contain product information						
Element 2: Access product information						
Select appropriate sources of product information						
Register to receive and/or access product information						
Visit suppliers and other sources to talk with sales staff and obtain items that may contain product information						
Access selected internal databases and internal business systems						
Access external sources of product information						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Interpret product information						
Identify specific sales needs that form the basis for the search for product information						
Read items that may contain product information						
Integrate sourced product information with identified client needs and/or preferences						
Element 4: Provide product information						
Interpret industry terminology						
Pass on general information relating to products and services						
Explain specific details about product and services						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

